



MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritius: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-09 · 25 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-09 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The month's substance is one document and one event. The omnibus bill introduced on 24 July to execute the 2026-2027 budget amends 58 Acts and creates the statutory frames for fintech governance, artificial intelligence, virtual-asset marketing, digital immigration and compulsory cyber threat-sharing – a legislative volume larger than any standalone technology act on the continent, arriving as a finance instrument. The state operator's summit on 16 and 17 July produced a cable commitment, a hyperscaler memorandum and a compute claim; reporting since has established what is contracted behind each.

Infrastructure

The Prime Minister announced on [16 July 2026](#) that [Mauritius will join the America-India Connect subsea cable programme](#). Reporting on [2 August](#) established [what sits behind it](#): a signed non-disclosure agreement, terms still under negotiation, no published timetable. The driver is ageing infrastructure – LION and LION2 still carry most international traffic – and the same account notes that Google already operates a ground station at Baie-du-Jacotet serviced by the state operator, so the cable would deepen a relationship rather than open one.

Two cyber measures moved. The [July omnibus would empower the central bank to establish a cyber threat intelligence sharing platform](#) and to require financial institutions, and others it specifies, to participate – the clearest instance of mandatory threat-intelligence sharing in primary legislation on this record. At a [workshop on 29 July](#) the postal operator began being wired into the Universal Postal Union's global postal threat-sharing centre, with the ICT minister naming ISO/IEC 27001 as the standard he wants adopted.

Cabinet also [approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia](#) putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons – an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Digital public infrastructure

The [omnibus bill of 24 July](#) puts the National Fintech Governance Committee on a statutory footing from 1 September 2026 — minister-chaired, seating the central bank governor, the financial regulator's chief executive, two ministries, the investment board and four private-sector members, empowered to approve sector-wide standards, and expressly not a body corporate. It was announced with the [fintech strategy on 25 June](#) and reached statute within a month.

The same bill redraws the virtual-asset perimeter around marketing rather than activity: unlicensed solicitation would be prohibited by any medium, reaching targeted advertising, platforms, social media, influencers, affiliates and referral codes, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius — which puts the burden on an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally. It also makes immigration permits issuable in digital form, imposes a digital travel authorisation on visa-exempt arrivals, and gives clinical trials a statutory electronic licensing system with the procedure written into the same Act as the channel.

On cross-border payments the state operator [announced a Mauritius-Seychelles corridor as a launch](#); no corroborating record from the partner fintech or either central bank is on file. A [South African Reserve Bank spokesperson said on 29 July that Mauritius is among four states considering onboarding to the Southern African settlement system](#) by end-2027 — another central bank's account of Mauritian intent.

The companion [Finance Bill, before Parliament from 27 July](#), widens what the statistics office may share with the finance ministry and imposes new declaration duties on public bodies — the state's data plumbing rewritten alongside its tax code, with no matching amendment to the Data Protection Act.

Governance and regulation

The [omnibus introduced on 24 July 2026](#) runs to 119 pages, amends 58 Acts and repeals one, commencing in stages from 1 September 2026. A [secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws](#); the enacting text gives the exact count. The Data Protection Act 2017 is not among the Acts amended: the digital provisions sit in five Acts and the safeguards Act is not one.

At the summit on [16 July the ICT minister committed the government to a National Data Governance Strategy and to Data Protection Act amendments](#) covering cybersecurity, privacy and children's online safety, and on [30 July to Electronic Transactions Act amendments](#). None carries a text or a date.

Mauritius was one of seven states covered by a [continental island-economies programme launched on 24 July](#) whose six pillars include digital transformation — a regional instrument, for the regional ledger rather than this one.

The month's sharpest domestic contribution was an argument about priority. A [named analyst published on 2 August](#) the case that contract enforcement rather than technology limits growth, citing the World Bank's 2025 indicators — 42.2 on ease of commercial dispute resolution against Singapore's 73.3 — and more than 70,000 cases pending at end-2025. Its digital prescription is digitalised case management alongside a small-claims process. Analysis, not evidence.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The [AI Registry went live on 9 July 2026](#), a week before the summit that showcased it: a directory of Mauritius-relevant models, agents and skills carrying provider identity and any institutional validation, which does not host or sell what it lists. The stack is open-sourced and is being offered to other operators.

The summit's other announcements differ in kind. The [Amazon memorandum was executed at the opening ceremony](#) with soft scope and no disclosed value, and [its training will run initially in rented premises](#). The claim that the operator's data centre already hosts current-generation accelerators is the chief executive's own. And the model-as-a-service work billed as a telecom first was [announced on 20 July](#) as work to define conformance criteria for a framework that does not yet exist. The [same keynote recorded a retreat](#): the schools pilot moved from a student tutor to a teacher assistant after teacher and parent resistance.

The month closed with the state's AI apparatus being measured from outside it. On [27 July the chamber of commerce and two partners launched an adoption, readiness and governance study](#), because there is no clear picture of adoption among Mauritian firms or of what skills exist. The ICT minister [put information technology at about 5.4% of gross domestic product against an ambition of 10-12%](#). The two accounts name different third partners.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

Nothing published in this period adds to the skills record beyond what the [June budget committed](#) — the 50,000-trainee target, the Rs 25m learning platform and the investment tax credit — and no enrolment figure against any of it has appeared. Mauritius remains a [gateway through which money moves into African markets](#) rather than a destination for digital-sector investment.

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